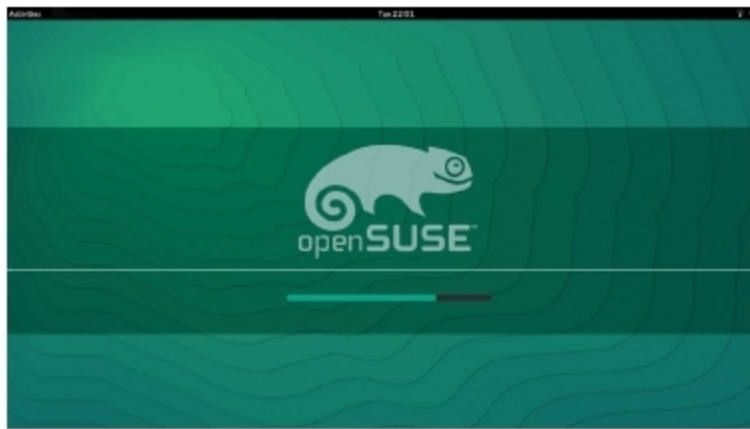


SUSE to focus on Asia-Pacific as independent firm

Open source software company SUSE, which recently reverted to being an independent company following the acquisition by growth investor EQT from Micro Focus for US\$ 2.5 billion, is now looking towards Asia-Pacific to drive its growth this year.

The company plans to boost its growing business in Asia by adding more people in emerging markets and strengthening call centre operations.

Andy Jiang, vice-president for SUSE in Asia-Pacific and Japan, told



Computer Weekly in Singapore, that the company is currently running its third largest engineering centre in Beijing, and has beefed up its call centre operations in Singapore.

Jiang revealed that the company had recently hired people in Indonesia and

Thailand. However, he didn't disclose specific headcount numbers.

In the Asia-Pacific region, SUSE serves customers across banking and financial services, telecom, manufacturing and government. It is also a leading open source vendor for the manufacturing industry in India.

The company has teamed up with enterprise software supplier SAP to run SAP workloads, including the high-performance Hana in-memory database, on SUSE's open source software stack.

"In manufacturing, we work with SAP very closely in China, Singapore and India," Jiang was quoted as saying.

Over the past eight years, SUSE has achieved strong growth in Asia-Pacific. It is estimated that revenue from the region is three times the size it was when SUSE became a business unit under Micro Focus in 2014.

SUSE's Asia-Pacific workforce has also grown more than twofold, with its system engineering team doubling in size. It also tripled the number of primary and dedicated support engineers and grew its sales force by 50 per cent.

The company is currently involved in more than 100 open source projects, supported by employees around the world.

Red Hat reports strong growth in FY 2019, based on its cloud enabling technologies

Red Hat Inc., the world's leading provider of open source solutions, has announced financial results for the fourth quarter and the full fiscal year 2019 ended February 28, 2019.

According to Jim Whitehurst, president and CEO of Red Hat, enterprises are continuing to move to hybrid cloud environments, and this trend is contributing to strong growth in Red Hat's cloud enabling technologies.

The company claims that across its portfolio, its total number of customers with active subscriptions greater than US\$ 5 million increased 33 per cent year-over-year in the fiscal year ending in the first quarter of 2019. The growth is primarily due to the increasing number of Ansible and OpenShift customers, which now total more than 1,300 and 1,000, respectively, as of the end of February 2019.

In FY19, the company continued to strengthen its strategic relationships with enterprise organisations, witnessing a 17 per cent year-over-year increase in the number of deals over US\$ 1 million.

Government school teachers in Tamil Nadu being trained in open source software

As many as 2,880 government school teachers have been provided training on the use of free and open source software (FOSS) by the State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT) as part of a project under the Tamil Nadu Innovation Initiative.



Under this project, SCERT has been conducting workshops across the state to encourage teachers to adapt and use technology available to them.

Asir Julius, assistant professor, SCERT, noted that unlike proprietary software, FOSS is free and easy to use, and users can customise the software based on their needs.

For the project, Julius said interactive tools were picked and 64 master resource persons, which included teachers from schools and District Institutes of Education and Training across the state, were trained.

The master resource persons, in turn, trained teachers in their respective districts through two-day workshops. The teachers were introduced to several tools and applications, such as the GeoGebra application to teach maths and the PhET application to teach scientific concepts through virtual simulations.

To enable teachers to access the software, SCERT has also set up an online portal which functions as a learning management system.